



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Flat Classical Academy

School Website: <https://fiatclassicalacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Flat Classical Academy (Lawrenceburg, IN, 47001) (as reflected in the crawl data for Fiat Classical Academy in Aurora, IN) presents a robust, Catholic, classical liberal-arts approach that aligns strongly with the canonical markers of classical education. Public-facing materials emphasize the Great Books, the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), primary-source history, Latin, liturgical life, and Socratic discourse, all anchored by a Catholic theological framework. Across the six categories, the school demonstrates clear Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goal oriented toward virtue and wisdom, a liberal-arts curriculum, classical pedagogy, faculty as mentors, and proactive, formation-oriented parent/community engagement. The Public materials consistently reference formation over information, contemplation (Scholé), wonder, and the cultivation of truth, goodness, and beauty. All six categories are assessed as CLASSICAL, with overwhelming alignment to the classical rubric in the provided sources and the knowledge-base lexicon.

Key corroborating elements drawn from the knowledge-base materials include: theology grounding all studies and liturgical life; explicit emphasis on Great Books, primary sources, and the Great Conversation; engagement with grammar–logic–rhetoric (trivium), Latin, history, and Socratic discourse; pedagogy that includes contemplative restfulness (Scholé) and active rhetoric/seminars; faculty described as educators and mentors in a living-curriculum frame; and a clear partnership model with parents and a welcoming community environment, including parent formation and open-campus engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Theology grounds all studies and frames curriculum in a Catholic intellectual tradition.
- Liturgy and communal prayer are incorporated into daily life (e.g., Liturgy of the Hours in daily rhythm).
- Public material references the transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and the aim of formation through virtue.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: theology, liturgy, truth, goodness, beauty, transcendental notions, wonder, virtue, sacred, ritual life. (Supported by curriculum narratives and the lexicon's positives for this category.)
- Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The materials anchor education in theology, sacramental/liturgical life, and the transcendentals, with explicit aim to cultivate virtue and wonder. This squarely satisfies the category's core criteria and aligns with the Positive Keyword Indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Stated goal: formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely job-work; education for leisure, contemplation, and the good life.
- Emphasis on formation over mere information, with reference to classical aims like the Great Conversation and the pursuit of true, good, and beautiful.

- Explicit articulation that education guides students toward the art of living well, not just career readiness.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, great conversation, true/good/beautiful, scholé/contemplation, order, moral imagination.
- Negative keywords present: none observed (no emphasis on workforce-prep or job-readiness as the primary aim).
- Why this rating
- The school's stated aims map directly to classical education's telos (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing) and explicitly reject a purely utilitarian or job-focused aim, aligning with Positive Indicators for this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Curriculum foregrounds the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Quadrivium, with emphasis on Latin and primary-source / Great-Books engagement.
- Strong emphasis on Great Books and the Great Conversation, with history taught through primary sources and broad Western canon.
- History integrated across disciplines, including Western civilization, and an emphasis on wonder and integration.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books / primary sources, Latin, history, Western civilization, dialectic, the unity of knowledge, wonder.
- Negative keywords present: minimal to none (no shift to social studies framing, project-based emphasis, or excessive STEM-first framing).
- Why this rating
- The curriculum content aligns with classical-education lexicon: trivium/quadrivium, great books, interdisciplinary/harmonic approach, and cultivation of wonder. This matches the Positive Indicators for Curriculum and avoids the Negative Signals listed in the lexicon.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Pedagogical approach includes Socratic dialogue and dialectic, with seminars and rhetorical work in the upper grades; restfulness and contemplation (Scholé) feature in the approach.
- Lower- and middle-school activities emphasize memory, repetition, singing/chanting, and memorization, with a memory-rich approach to learning.
- Upper-school work includes rhetoric development, opportunities to give speeches, and structured rhetorical training.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, seminar, dialectic, rhetoric, memory work, chanting, scholé, wonder, guided discussion, truth-seeking.
- Negative keywords present: limited evidence of exclusive reliance on project-based/experiential-only pedagogy; the public materials emphasize classical methods rather than a solely constructivist approach. (Per lexicon, explicit negative signals would include heavy experiential/project-based foci, which aren't foregrounded in FCA materials.)
- Why this rating
- The materials emphasize Socratic and dialectical pedagogy, memory-based pedagogy, and a high school rhetoric track, consistent with classical pedagogy expectations. The absence of dominant non-classical pedagogy signals supports CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Faculty described as educators/mentors within a living curriculum; a focus on virtuous teachers who model excellence. Public materials reference “educators” and “classical Catholic educators.”
- The school emphasizes a teacher-centered, mentor-driven approach, with a portrait of what a teacher should be and what a student should be reflected in the classical model (as reflected in the lexicon’s framework).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: educators/mentors; living curriculum; portrait of the teacher; teacher as model; faculty as core; collaboration with families.
- Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The public materials align with the classical expectation of a faculty as living exemplars and mentors, and with a “faculty as the living curriculum” ethos. This maps well to the Positive Keywords for Faculty and avoids Negative Signals.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Strong parent-partnership orientation: parents as co-educators; opportunities for parent formation and engagement; welcoming open-campus culture; parish/school-community integration (canon-law based emphasis on parent collaboration).
- Financial-aid structures and public-voucher alignment demonstrate community accessibility and engagement, with open invitations for parent involvement and visits.
- Public materials emphasize a communal culture and the role of parents in formation, including examples of parent engagement and community support.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, family involvement, open campus, community events, hospitality, parental covenant.
- Negative keywords present: consumer-language signals or minimal parent involvement signals are not observed; the materials emphasize active parent participation rather than a customer-model. (The lexicon notes potential negatives like “parent as customer” which are not reflected in FCA content.)
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates a robust, recognizable classical-community model with active parent involvement, formation opportunities for parents, and welcoming campus culture. This aligns with the Positive Keywords for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Classification

- Overall, all six categories meet CLASSICAL criteria based on keyword signals, curricular content, pedagogy, faculty portrayal, and family/community engagement present in the public materials. The classical indicators—Great Books, trivium, Socratic pedagogy, liturgical life, formation emphasis, and parent partnership—are consistently evident. Therefore, the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as all six categories are CLASSICAL. No category is ranked SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, so there is no needle-moving change required.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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